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Polarization maintaining fiber with alignment features

Abstract

Embodiments disclosed herein include an optical fiber. In an embodiment, the optical fiber comprises a core and a cladding around the core. In an embodiment, a first rod is within the cladding and adjacent to the core. In an embodiment, the first rod comprises a magnetic material. In an embodiment, the optical fiber further comprises a second rod within the cladding and adjacent to the core, where the first rod and the second rod are on opposite sides of the core.

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Background/Summary

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) Embodiments of the present disclosure relate to electronic packages, and more particularly to optoelectronic packages with polarization maintaining fibers with alignment features.

BACKGROUND

(2) Photonics devices allow for high bandwidth signaling. Accordingly, photonics devices are being

increasingly used as the communication architecture for advanced electronic packaging systems. In some instances, the photonics devices include an optical fiber that is optically coupled to a photonics integrated circuit (PIC). For example, the optical fiber may be placed in a V-groove on the PIC. For single mode fibers, the placement of the fiber into the V-groove is simplified since the fiber may have any rotational orientation.

(3) However, in advanced photonics devices polarization maintaining fibers (PMFs) are used. By design, PMFs have a non-symmetric cross-section about all orientations. Particularly, a pair of stress rods are on opposite sides of a core. As such, the PMF is not uniform about different degrees of rotation. This is particularly problematic since the stress rods and the core need to be properly aligned in order to function properly. Accordingly, the PMFs need to be manually inserted into the V-groove while monitoring the PMF orientation. Due to the extra assembly complexity, PMFs are expensive to use, and are hindering silicon photonics from being used in consumer products.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1A is a cross-sectional illustration of an optical fiber with a core and a cladding, in accordance with an embodiment.
- (2) FIG. 1B is a cross-sectional illustration of polarization maintaining fiber (PMF) with a core and a pair of rods adjacent to the core, in accordance with an embodiment.
- (3) FIG. 1C is a plan view illustration of a photonics system with optical fibers from a fiber array unit (FAU) that are to be inserted into V-grooves, in accordance with an embodiment.
- (4) FIG. 2A is a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF with a pair of magnetic rods adjacent to the core, in accordance with an embodiment.
- (5) FIG. 2B is a cross-sectional illustration of a plurality of PMFs magnetically coupled to each other, in accordance with an embodiment.
- (6) FIG. 3A is a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF with a magnetic rod and a metal rod adjacent to the core, in accordance with an embodiment.
- (7) FIG. 3B is a cross-sectional illustration of a plurality of PMFs magnetically coupled to each other, in accordance with an embodiment.
- (8) FIG. 4 is a perspective view illustration of a PMF ribbon with a molded end and a pigtail end, in accordance with an embodiment.
- (9) FIGS. 5A-5C are cross-sectional illustrations depicting a process for aligning PMFs in V-grooves by applying an electromagnetic field to the PMFs, in accordance with an embodiment.
- (10) FIGS. 6A-6C are cross-sectional illustrations depicting a process for aligning PMFs in grooves by placing magnetic structures in the sidewall of the grooves, in accordance with an embodiment.
- (11) FIG. 7A is a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF with four rods, where one of the rods is magnetic, in accordance with an embodiment.
- (12) FIG. 7B is a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF with four rods, where two of the rods are magnetic, in accordance with an embodiment.
- (13) FIG. 8 is a perspective view illustration of an FAU coupled to a metal chassis with the PMF ribbon magnetically coupled to the chassis, in accordance with an embodiment.
- (14) FIG. 9 is a perspective view illustration of a process for forming a PMF, in accordance with an embodiment.
- (15) FIGS. 10A and 10B are perspective view illustration of a PMF with a housing for interfacing with a connector, in accordance with an embodiment.
- (16) FIG. 11A is a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF within a housing, in accordance with an embodiment.
- (17) FIG. 11B is a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF with a housing partially around the PMF,

and where protrusions on the PMF interface with grooves on the housing, in accordance with an embodiment.

(18) FIG. 11C is a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF with a housing partially around the PMF, and where protrusions on the housing interface with grooves on the PMF, in accordance with an embodiment.

(19) FIG. 12A is a perspective view illustration of a PMF with a housing, in accordance with an embodiment.

(20) FIG. 12B is a perspective view illustration of a plurality of PMFs and housings in an array, in accordance with an embodiment.

(21) FIG. 13A is a perspective view illustration of a connector, in accordance with an embodiment.

(22) FIG. 13B is a perspective view illustration of a connector with lenses, in accordance with an embodiment.

(23) FIG. 13C is a perspective view illustration of an angled connector, in accordance with an embodiment.

(24) FIG. 14A is a perspective view illustration of an array of PMFs that are connected with straight connectors, in accordance with an embodiment.

(25) FIG. 14B is a perspective view illustration of an array of PMFs that are connected with angled connectors, in accordance with an embodiment.

(26) FIG. 15A is a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF with an alignment structure that comprises a protrusion and a groove, in accordance with an embodiment.

(27) FIG. 15B is a cross-sectional illustration of a plurality of PMFs that are connected with an alignment structure, in accordance with an embodiment.

(28) FIG. 15C is a cross-sectional illustration of a plurality of PMFs that are aligned with each other and surrounded by a mold layer, in accordance with an embodiment.

(29) FIG. 16A is a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF with an alignment structure that comprises a pair of protrusions, in accordance with an embodiment.

(30) FIG. 16B is a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF with an alignment structure that comprises a pair of grooves, in accordance with an embodiment.

(31) FIG. 16C is a cross-sectional illustration of a plurality of PMFs that are aligned with each other and surrounded by a mold layer, in accordance with an embodiment.

(32) FIG. 17A is a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF with an alignment structure that comprises a protrusion, in accordance with an embodiment.

(33) FIG. 17B is a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF with an alignment structure that comprises a groove, in accordance with an embodiment.

(34) FIG. 17C is a cross-sectional illustration of a first PMF aligned with a second PMF, in accordance with an embodiment.

(35) FIG. 17D is a cross-sectional illustration of a plurality of PMFs coupled to each other with alignment features, in accordance with an embodiment.

(36) FIG. 17E is a cross-sectional illustration of a plurality of PMFs that are aligned with each other and surrounded by a mold layer, in accordance with an embodiment.

(37) FIG. 18A is a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF with a pair of marking rods partially embedded in an outer cladding, in accordance with an embodiment.

(38) FIG. 18B is a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF with a marking rod and a groove, in accordance with an embodiment.

(39) FIG. 18C is a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF with a pair of grooves, in accordance with an embodiment.

(40) FIG. 19A is a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF with a marking rod partially embedded in an outer cladding, in accordance with an embodiment.

(41) FIG. 19B is a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF with a groove in an outer cladding, in accordance with an embodiment.

(42) FIG. 20 is a cross-sectional illustration of an electronic system with a photonics integrated circuit (PIC) that is optically coupled to a PMF, in accordance with an embodiment.

(43) FIG. 21 is a schematic of a computing device built in accordance with an embodiment.

EMBODIMENTS OF THE PRESENT DISCLOSURE

(44) Described herein are optoelectronic packages with polarization maintaining fibers with alignment features, in accordance with various embodiments. In the following description, various aspects of the illustrative implementations will be described using terms commonly employed by those skilled in the art to convey the substance of their work to others skilled in the art. However, it will be apparent to those skilled in the art that the present invention may be practiced with only some of the described aspects. For purposes of explanation, specific numbers, materials and configurations are set forth in order to provide a thorough understanding of the illustrative implementations. However, it will be apparent to one skilled in the art that the present invention may be practiced without the specific details. In other instances, well-known features are omitted or simplified in order not to obscure the illustrative implementations.

(45) Various operations will be described as multiple discrete operations, in turn, in a manner that is most helpful in understanding the present invention, however, the order of description should not be construed to imply that these operations are necessarily order dependent. In particular, these operations need not be performed in the order of presentation.

(46) The most commonly used optical fiber in existing optical systems for optoelectronic packaging is a single mode fiber. A cross-sectional illustration of such a fiber 100 is shown in FIG. 1A. As shown, the fiber 100 comprises a core 112 and a cladding 110 surrounding the core 112. In an embodiment, the core 112 may comprise a glass material or any other suitable material for propagating optical signals. In order to improve the performance of optical systems, the use of polarization maintaining fibers (PMFs) have been proposed. PMFs work by intentionally introducing a systematic linear birefringence in the fiber 100, so that there are two well defined polarization modes which propagate along the fiber with distinct phase velocities.

(47) An example of a PMF 100 is shown in FIG. 1B. As shown, the PMF 100 comprises a core 112 with a cladding 110. In addition to the core 112, a pair of rods 115 are provided within the cladding 110. The rods 115 may induce a stress in the PMF fiber 100. In some instances the rods 115 may be referred to as stress rods. Stress permanently induced in the PMF 100 will generate a stress birefringence.

(48) The rods 115 are aligned with each other on opposite sides of the core 112. As used herein, rods 115 and cores 112 that are said to be aligned with each other refers to an orientation where a single linear line can be drawn that passes through a center point of all of the features. That is, in FIG. 1B, a single linear line can be drawn that passes through a center point of the first rod 115 on the left, a center point of the core 112, and a center point of the second rod 115 on the right. It is to be appreciated that manufacturing tolerances may result in the rods 115 and the core 112 being slightly offset from each other. For example, the center points of the rods 115 and the core 112 may be within approximately 10 μm of being perfectly aligned with each other. The rods 115 may be any suitable material. In some instances, the rods 115 may comprise boron trioxide (B.sub.2O.sub.3). In other instances, the rods 115 may comprise metallic materials.

(49) PMFs maintain the linear polarization of linearly polarized light so long as the light is launched into the PMF aligned with one of the PMF's polarization modes. Accordingly, properly aligning the PMF is critical. As shown in FIG. 1C, a plan view illustration of an electronic package 120 with a photonics integrated circuit (PIC) 122 is shown. The PIC 122 may include a plurality of grooves 123 into which PMFs 100 from a fiber array unit 124 are inserted. In order to properly align the PMFs 100, each PMF is manually inserted into the groove 123 while monitoring the orientation of the PMF 100. Accordingly, assembly complexity is increased, which leads to an increase in the cost of using PMFs. The added cost and complexity makes it undesirable to use PMFs 100 unless absolutely necessary.

(50) Accordingly, embodiments disclosed herein include PMF architectures that enable self-aligning the individual PMFs. Aligning the PMFs allows for the creation of fiber ribbons that maintain the necessary fiber orientation. The pigtail ends of the fiber ribbons can then be inserted into grooves of the PIC without needing to check the orientation of the fibers. In one embodiment, the fibers are self-aligned with a magnetic process. For example, one or both of the rods may be replaced with a magnetic material. The rods will then be magnetically attracted to each other and align in the proper orientations. In other embodiments, the PMFs may be inserted into a V-groove, and a magnetic field is applied to properly orient the PMFs. In yet another embodiment, the groove sidewalls include magnets or magnetic metals that are used to align the PMFs.

(51) In yet another embodiment, housings may be secured to the ends of the PMFs. The PMFs are properly aligned within the housing and secured. The housing can then be inserted into a connector, and the alignment will persist. The housings may be attached to the PMFs with protrusion and groove architectures, or through the use of an adhesive.

(52) In other embodiments, the PMFs may be fabricated with an outer cladding that includes a protrusion and/or a groove. The PMFs with protrusions couple with PMFs with the grooves, with the protrusions fitting into the groove. The protrusions and grooves are configured to properly align the PMFs when coupled together.

(53) Referring now to FIG. 2A, a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF **200** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, the PMF **200** may comprise a core **212**. The core **212** may comprise a glass material, though it is to be appreciated that other types of materials may also be used. As shown, the core **212** is surrounded by a cladding **210**. In an embodiment, the diameter of the cladding **210** may be between approximately 50 μm and approximately 150 μm . The cladding **210** may be a polymer material.

(54) In an embodiment, a pair of rods **215** may be provided in the cladding **210**. The rods **215** may be on opposite sides of the core **212**. In a particular embodiment, the rods **215** may be aligned with the core **212** so that a single linear line can be drawn that passes through center points of the two rods **215** and the core **212**. The rods **215** may be substantially similar to each other. For example, a material composition and diameter of the two rods **215** may be substantially the same. In an embodiment, the rods **215** have diameters that are larger than a diameter of the core **212**. In the illustrated embodiment, the rods **215** are shown as being substantially circular. However, it is to be appreciated that the rods **215** may have any cross-sectional shape suitable for PMF applications. For example, the rods **215** may have a cross-sectional shape that is commonly referred to as a bow-tie configuration.

(55) In an embodiment, the rods **215** may comprise a magnetic material. For example, the magnetic material may be a magnetic powder that is mixed in with a non-magnetic base material. The particles of the magnetic material may be smaller than the diameter of the rods **215** in order to not impact the stress distribution in the PMF **200**. In a particular embodiment, the magnetic material may comprise nanoparticles, such as ferrite nanoparticles. In one embodiment, ferrite nanoparticles may be mixed with boron trioxide (B.sub.2O.sub.3).

(56) Referring now to FIG. 2B, a cross-sectional illustration of an array **205** of PMFs **200** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. As shown, each of the PMFs **200** may be substantially similar to the PMF **200** described above with respect to FIG. 2A. For example, the PMFs **200** may comprise a core **212** surrounded by a cladding **210**. Rods **215** may be provided adjacent to the core **212** within the cladding **210**. Since the rods **215** comprise magnetic material, the rods **215** become magnetically attracted to each other. As such, the PMFs **200** align laterally with each other in order to minimize the distances between rods **215** on neighboring PMFs **200**. In the illustrated embodiment five PMFs **200** are shown. However, it is to be appreciated that any number of PMFs **200** may be included in the array **205**.

(57) Referring now to FIG. 3A, a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF **300** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, the PMF **300** may comprise a core **312**. The core **312** may

comprise a glass material, though it is to be appreciated that other types of materials may also be used. In an embodiment, the core **312** is surrounded by a cladding **310**. The diameter of the cladding **310** may be between approximately 50 μm and approximately 150 μm . The cladding **310** may be a polymer material.

(58) In an embodiment, a pair of rods **315** may be provided in the cladding **310**. The rods **315** may be on opposite sides of the core **312**. In a particular embodiment, the rods **315** may be aligned with the core **312** so that a single linear line can be drawn that passes through center points of the two rods **315** and the core **312**. The diameter of the rods **315** may be substantially similar to each other. In an embodiment, the rods **315** have diameters that are larger than a diameter of the core **312**. In the illustrated embodiment, the rods **315** are shown as being substantially circular. However, it is to be appreciated that the rods **315** may have any cross-sectional shape suitable for PMF applications.

(59) In an embodiment, a first rod **315.sub.A** may comprise a magnetic material. For example, the magnetic material may be a magnetic powder that is mixed in with a non-magnetic base material. The particles of the magnetic material may be smaller than the diameter of the first rod **315.sub.A** in order to not impact the stress distribution in the PMF **300**. In a particular embodiment, the magnetic material may comprise nanoparticles, such as ferrite nanoparticles. In one embodiment, ferrite nanoparticles may be mixed with boron trioxide (**B.sub.2O.sub.3**).

(60) In an embodiment, a second rod **315.sub.B** may comprise a magnetic metal. Particularly, the magnetic material may be a material that is attracted to the magnetic material of the first rod **315.sub.A**. For example, the second rod **315.sub.B** may comprise iron, nickel, cobalt, or the like. The magnetic component of the second rod **315.sub.B** may be a powder that is mixed with another material, such as boron trioxide (**B.sub.2O.sub.3**).

(61) Referring now to FIG. **3B**, a cross-sectional illustration of an array **305** of PMFs **300** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. The PMFs **300** in FIG. **3B** may be substantially similar to the PMF **300** in FIG. **3A**. As shown, the PMFs **300** are aligned with each other so that first rods **315.sub.A** are adjacent to second rods **315.sub.B** in neighboring PMFs **300**. This minimizes the distance between the first rods **315.sub.A** and the second rods **315.sub.B**. Such an embodiment is beneficial in that the handling of the PMFs **300** is made easier compared to the embodiment shown in FIG. **2A**. This is because only one side is magnetic, and the PMFs do not stick to each other in every direction.

(62) Referring now to FIG. **4**, a perspective view illustration of an array **405** of PMFs **400** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In the illustrated embodiment, the PMFs **400** are substantially similar to the PMF **200** in FIG. **2A**. That is, the PMFs **400** comprise a core **412** with a cladding **410**. Rods **415** that are magnetic may be on opposite sides of the core **412**. Though, it is to be appreciated that array **405** may alternatively have PMFs **400** that are similar to the PMF **300** in FIG. **3A**. For example, the PMFs **400** may include a first rod **415** that is magnetic and a second rod **415** that is a metallic material that is attracted to the magnetic first rod **415**. While four PMFs **400** are shown in the array **405**, it is to be appreciated that any number of PMFs **400** may be included in the array **405**.

(63) In an embodiment, the array **405** may include a mold layer **411** that is around the PMFs **400**. The mold layer **411** may bundle the array **405** of PMFs **400** into a ribbon-like architecture. Additionally, the mold layer **411** locks in the orientation of the PMFs **400** so that they do not rotate. As such, the pigtail end of the array **405** (i.e., the end of the array **405** not surrounded by the mold layer **411**) can be inserted into grooves or the like with constrained PMFs **400** that are not free to rotate. Since the pigtail ends of the PMFs **400** cannot rotate, the PMFs **400** will be properly aligned when inserted into a groove or the like.

(64) Referring now to FIGS. **5A-5C**, a series of cross-sectional illustrations depicting a process for aligning PMFs **500** in grooves **523** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. Referring now to FIG. **5A**, a cross-sectional illustration of a portion of a PIC **522** with grooves **523** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, the grooves **523** may be V-grooves, though

grooves with other shapes may also be used in some embodiments. Additionally, while described as a PIC 522, it is to be appreciated that similar alignment processes may be implemented with grooves on other structures (e.g., on a fiber array unit (FAU) or the like).

(65) In an embodiment, the PMFs 500 may each comprise a core 512 and a cladding 510 around the core 512. Rods 515 may be provided on opposite sides of the core 512 within the cladding 510. In an embodiment, the rods 515 comprise a magnetic material. In a particular embodiment, the PMFs 500 may be substantially similar to the PMFs 200 described above with respect to FIG. 2A. In an embodiment, the PMFs 500 may be over a curable adhesive 526 that is in the bottom of the grooves 523.

(66) As shown in FIG. 5A, the PMFs 500 have non-uniform rotations within the grooves 523. That is, the PMFs 500 may be placed in the grooves 523 without any particular concern as to their orientation. Such an embodiment may occur when the PMFs 500 are not bundled (as is shown in FIG. 4). Instead, the PMFs 500 may be considered loose fibers. Additionally, the PMFs 500 may be far enough apart from each other so that the magnetic rods 515 do not initiate a self-aligning action, similar to what is shown in FIG. 2B.

(67) Referring now to FIG. 5B, a cross-sectional illustration of the PIC 522 after the PMFs 500 are aligned is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, the PMFs 500 may be aligned by applying an electro-magnetic field 531 over the PIC 522. The electro-magnetic field 531 interacts with the magnetic rods 515 and results in the PMFs 500 rotating to align with the electro-magnetic field 531. At this point in the process, the curable adhesive 526 is uncured, so the PMFs 500 are free to rotate within the grooves 523. As shown, the PMFs 500 are all aligned so that a single linear line can be drawn that passes through the center points of all of the cores 512 and the rods 515.

(68) Referring now to FIG. 5C, a cross-sectional illustration of the PIC 522 after the PMFs 500 are secured in the grooves 523 is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. As shown, additional adhesive 526 may be applied around the top halves of the PMFs 500. A glass plate 532 may then be pressed down onto the PMFs 500. In an embodiment, the adhesive 526 may then be cured to lock the PMFs 500 in the proper orientation. In an embodiment, the adhesive 526 may be cured with a UV exposure, a temperature cure, or the like.

(69) Referring now to FIGS. 6A-6C, a series of cross-sectional illustrations depicting a process for aligning PMFs 600 in grooves 623 is shown, in accordance with an additional embodiment. In the embodiment shown in FIGS. 6A-6C, the PMFs 600 are aligned with magnetic attraction in the grooves 623 of a PIC 622.

(70) Referring now to FIG. 6A, the grooves 623 may be square grooves, though grooves with other shapes may also be used in some embodiments. Additionally, while described as a PIC 622, it is to be appreciated that similar alignment processes may be implemented with grooves on other structures (e.g., on a fiber array unit (FAU) or the like).

(71) In an embodiment, the PMFs 600 may each comprise a core 612 and a cladding 610 around the core 612. Rods 615 may be provided on opposite sides of the core 612 within the cladding 610. In an embodiment, the rods 615 comprise a magnetic material. In a particular embodiment, the PMFs 600 may be substantially similar to the PMFs 200 described above with respect to FIG. 2A. In an embodiment, the PMFs 600 may be over a curable adhesive 626 that is in the bottom of the grooves 623. In an embodiment, metallic guides 633 may be provided in the sidewalls of the grooves 623.

(72) As shown in FIG. 6A, the PMFs 600 have non-uniform rotations within the grooves 623. That is, the PMFs 600 may be placed in the grooves 623 without any particular concern as to their orientation. Such an embodiment may occur when the PMFs 600 are not bundled (as is shown in FIG. 4). Instead, the PMFs 600 may be considered loose fibers. Additionally, the PMFs 600 may be far enough apart from each other so that the magnetic rods 615 do not initiate a self-aligning action, similar to what is shown in FIG. 2B.

(73) Referring now to FIG. 6B, a cross-sectional illustration of the PIC 622 after the PMFs 600 are aligned is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, the PMFs 600 may self-align by having the magnetic rods 615 attract to the metallic guides 633. In some embodiments vibration or some mechanical stress may be used to accelerate the self-aligning process. As shown, the adhesive 626 is uncured at this point in order to allow for the PMFs 600 to rotate into the proper orientation.

(74) Referring now to FIG. 6C, a cross-sectional illustration of the PIC 622 after the adhesive 626 is cured to form cured adhesive 627 is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, the cured adhesive 627 may be cured with a UV exposure 628, a temperature cure, or the like. In some embodiments, additional adhesive may be provided over a top half of the PMFs 600. A glass top similar to the glass layer 532 in FIG. 5C may also be included in some embodiments.

(75) Referring now to FIG. 7A, a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF 700 is shown in accordance with an additional embodiment. The PMF 700 may comprise a core 712 that is surrounded by a cladding 710. The core 712 may be a glass material or the like, and the cladding may be a plastic material. In an embodiment, a plurality of rods 715 may be provided around the core 712 within the cladding 710. In a particular embodiment, four rods 715 are shown. The rods 715 may be evenly distributed around a perimeter of the core 712. For example, each rod 715 has a 90° separation from the next rod 715. In an embodiment, a first rod 715.sub.A has a magnetic material. For example, the first rod 715.sub.A may comprise ferrite nanoparticles, or any other magnetic material. The second rods 715.sub.B may be a material that is magnetically attracted to the first rod 715.sub.A. For example, the second rods 715.sub.B may comprise iron, nickel, cobalt, or the like. In some embodiments, only the second rod 715.sub.B on the opposite side of the core 712 from the first rod 715.sub.A may comprise a metallic. The other second rods 715.sub.B (i.e., the topmost rod 715.sub.B in FIG. 7A and the bottommost rod 715.sub.B in FIG. 7A) may comprise non-metallic materials, such as boron trioxide (B.sub.2O.sub.3).

(76) Referring now to FIG. 7B, a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF 700 is shown, in accordance with an additional embodiment. In an embodiment, the PMF 700 in FIG. 7B may be substantially similar to the PMF 700 in FIG. 7A, with the exception of the inclusion of an additional first rod 715.sub.A. The additional first rod 715.sub.A may be on the opposite side of the core 712 from the other first rod 715.sub.A. Additionally, the second rods 715.sub.B in FIG. 7B may not be metallic rods. As such, the rods 715.sub.B may not be attracted to the first rods 715.sub.A. Accordingly The PMF 700 may self-align with other PMFs 700 by the magnetic first rods 715.sub.A being attracted to each other.

(77) Referring now to FIG. 8, a perspective view illustration of metal chassis body is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, the chassis may be used in a server environment or the like. As such, cable management can be a difficult parameter to control. Embodiments disclosed herein provide improved fiber management because the fiber ribbon 805 is magnetic and can magnetically attach to the metal plate 814. In the illustrated embodiment, an FAU 824 is provided on a bottom plate 813. A fiber ribbon 805 may extend out from the FAU 824 and attach to the top plate 814 with a magnetic attachment. In an embodiment, the fiber ribbon 805 may be substantially similar to any of the fiber arrays and/or fiber ribbons described above. For example, self-aligned PMFs may be bundled together and surrounded by a molding material in order to form the fiber ribbon 805.

(78) Referring now to FIG. 9, a perspective view illustration of a device for forming PMFs 900 is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, a PMF 900 starts with a wide diameter cladding 910. The core 912 and the rods 915 are provided through the cladding 910. The cladding 910 may have a first diameter D.sub.1 above a heater 906. The PMF 900 is pulled through the heater 906 which allows for the fiber with a second diameter D.sub.2 to be drawn (as indicated by the dashed arrow). In a particular embodiment, the temperature of the heater 906 may be below

the melting point of the magnetic material in the rods **915**. For example, the melting temperature of the ferrite particles in the rods **915** may be approximately 300° C. As such, the cladding **910** should be a material that has a melting temperature lower than 300° C. in order to allow for the cladding **910** to be drawn without damaging the magnetic properties of the rods **915**.

(79) Referring now to FIGS. **10A** and **10B**, perspective view illustrations of a PMF **1000** is shown, in accordance with an additional embodiment. Instead of relying on magnetic features to align the PMF **1000**, embodiments shown in FIGS. **10A** and **10B** use a mechanical housing **1050** that is secured to the PMF **1000** and attached to a connector **1055**.

(80) Referring now to FIG. **10A**, a perspective view illustration of PMF **1000** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, a housing **1050** is attached to an end of the PMF **1000**. The housing **1050** is attached to the PMF **1000** so that the PMF **1000** has a known orientation. For example, the core and rods of the PMF **1000** are aligned from left to right. Since the orientation is locked by the housing **1050**, a macro sized mechanical device is used to set the alignment of the PMF **1000** with respect to a connector **1055**. As shown, the connector **1055** may include a cutout to receive a latch **1051** on the housing.

(81) Referring now to FIG. **10B**, a perspective view illustration of the PMF **1000** after it is inserted into the connector **1055** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, the connector wraps around the housing **1050** and the PMF **1000**. The latch **1051** extends up into the cutout in the connector **1055** in order to secure the housing **1050** in the connector **1055**. In an embodiment, the latch **1051** may be pressed down in order to release the housing **1050** from the connector **1055**.

(82) Referring now to FIGS. **11A-11C** a series of cross-sectional illustrations of ends of the PMF **1100** surrounded by a housing **1150** is shown, in accordance with various embodiments. The different FIGS. **11A-11C** provide alternative implementations of how the housing **1150** can be coupled to the PMF **1100**.

(83) Referring now to FIG. **11A**, a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF **1100** in a housing **1150** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, the PMF **1100** comprises a first cladding **1110** that surrounds a core **1112** and rods **1115**. In an embodiment, a second cladding **1109** may be provided around the first cladding **1110**. The PMF **1100** may be inserted into the housing **1150**. The PMF **1100** may be secured to the housing with an adhesive **1126**. After the PMF **1100** is aligned with the housing **1150**, the adhesive **1126** may be cured in order to lock the orientation of the PMF **1100**.

(84) In an embodiment, the housing **1150** completely surrounds a perimeter of the PMF **1100**. For example, the housing **1150** may be a frame shaped structure, and the PMF **1100** fits into the interior of the frame of the housing **1150**. In the illustrated embodiment, the width and the height of the opening in the housing **1150** may be substantially equal to the outer diameter of the second cladding **1109** of the PMF **1100**. That is, the second cladding **1109** may contact interior surfaces of the frame of the housing **1150**. However, in other embodiments the diameter of the second cladding **1109** may be smaller than the width and the height of the opening in the housing **1150**.

(85) In an embodiment, the housing **1150** may be configured to interface with a connector (not shown). The housing **1150** may include features that secure the housing to the connector. For example, the housing **1150** may comprise a latch **1151**. The latch **1151** appears floating in the cross-sectional illustration shown in FIG. **11A**. However, it is to be appreciated that the latch **1151** is connected to the remainder of the housing **1150** outside of the plane illustrated in FIG. **11A**.

(86) Referring now to FIG. **11B**, a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF **1100** that is secured by a housing **1150** is shown, in accordance with an additional embodiment. In an embodiment, the housing **1150** partially surrounds a perimeter of the PMF **1100**. For example, the housing **1150** surrounds the top half of the PMF **1100** in FIG. **11B**. In an embodiment, the PMF **1100** is secured to the housing **1150** with a protrusion and groove architecture. For example, the PMF **1100** may include protrusions **1113**. The protrusions **1113** may be adjacent to the rods **1115**. That is, the rods

1115, the core **1112**, and the protrusions **1113** may be aligned in a line. In an embodiment, the housing **1150** may include grooves **1152**. The grooves **1152** may be shaped to accommodate the protrusions **1113**. Inserting the protrusions **1113** into the grooves **1152** properly aligns the PMF **1100** with the housing **1150**.

(87) Referring now to FIG. **11C**, a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF **1100** that is secured by a housing **1150** is shown, in accordance with an additional embodiment. In an embodiment, the PMF **1100** and the housing **1150** shown in FIG. **11C** are substantially similar to the PMF **1100** and the housing **1150** shown in FIG. **11B**, with the exception of the interface between the PMF **1100** and the housing **1150**. Instead of having protrusions extending out from the second cladding **1109**, protrusions **1153** are formed as part of the housing **1150**. The protrusions **1153** interface with grooves **1114** formed into the second cladding **1109**. Similar to the embodiment shown in FIG. **11B**, the protrusion **1153** and the groove **1114** architecture allows for the PMF **1100** to be aligned with the housing **1150**.

(88) Referring now to FIG. **12A**, a perspective view illustration of a PMF **1200** and a housing **1250** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, the housing **1250** is provided at an end of the PMF **1200**. In the embodiment illustrated in FIG. **12A**, the housing **1250** is similar to the housings shown in FIG. **11B** or **11C**. That is, the housing **1250** partially surrounds a perimeter of the PMF **1200**. For example, the housing **1250** wraps around a top half of the PMF **1200**, and is secured to the sides of the PMF **1200** (e.g., with a protrusion and groove architecture). In an embodiment, the housing **1250** may include a latch **1250** to affix the housing **1250** to a connector (not shown).

(89) Referring now to FIG. **12B**, a perspective view illustration of an array of PMFs **1200.sub.A-1200.sub.N** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In the illustrated embodiment, ten PMFs **1200** are shown, but it is to be appreciated that any number of PMFs **1200** may be included in the array. The PMFs **1200** may be adjacent to each other in order to form a line of PMFs **1200**. In an embodiment, the rods of the PMFs **1200** may all be aligned with each other. In an embodiment, the PMFs **1200** may each be surrounded by a housing **1250**. The housings **1250** may be any housing architecture described herein. In the particular embodiment, shown in FIG. **12B**, the housings **1250** partially wrap around the PMFs **1200** and are attached with a groove and protrusion architecture. In an embodiment, the housings **1250** may be discrete elements. In other embodiments, the housings **1250** may be coupled to each other. For example, the housings **1250** may share sidewalls.

(90) Referring now to FIGS. **13A-13C**, a series of perspective view illustrations of connectors **1355** are shown, in accordance with various embodiments. In FIG. **13A**, a straight connector is shown. In FIG. **13B**, a straight connector with lenses is shown. In FIG. **13C**, an angled connector is shown.

(91) Referring now to FIG. **13A**, a perspective view illustration of a connector is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In the illustrated embodiment, the connector comprises a first connector **1355.sub.A** and a second connector **1355.sub.B**. The first connector **1355.sub.A** is coupled to the second connector **1355.sub.B** in order to optically couple a first PMF to a second PMF (not shown). In an embodiment, each connector **1355** comprises a notch **1356** to secure latches of the PMFs. In the illustrated embodiment, the connectors **1355.sub.A** and **1355.sub.B** are linearly aligned. That is, there is no turn between the first connector **1355.sub.A** and the second connector **1355.sub.B**.

(92) Referring now to FIG. **13B**, a perspective view illustration of a connector with lenses **1357** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, the connector in FIG. **13B** may be substantially similar to the connector in FIG. **13A**, with the addition of lenses **1357**. In an embodiment, each of the connectors **1355.sub.A** and **1355.sub.B** may be terminated with a lens **1357**. In an embodiment, the lenses **1357** provide improved optical coupling between PMFs connected to the connectors **1355**.

(93) Referring now to FIG. **13C**, a perspective view illustration of a connector that is angled is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, the first connector **1355.sub.A** and

the second connector **1355.sub.B** are oriented 90° with respect to each other. As such, an optical signal may be turned without having to bend an optical fiber. In an embodiment, a first PMF in the first connector **1355.sub.A** is coupled to a second PMF in the second connector **1355.sub.B** with lenses **1357** and a mirror **1358**. The mirror may be at a 45° angle to the connectors **1355** in order to allow for the 90° turn. In other embodiments, the mirror **1358** may be at different angles in order to provide a connector that has a turn of a different angle.

(94) Referring now to FIG. **14A**, a perspective view illustration of a plurality of PMFs **1400** connected with a connector **1455** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, the connectors **1455** are linear connectors. That is, PMFs **1400.sub.A** on a first end of the connectors **1455** are linearly connected to PMFs **1400.sub.B** on a second end of the connectors **1455**. In an embodiment, the connectors **1455** may be discrete from each other. In other embodiments, the connectors **1455** may be coupled to each other. While ten connectors **1455** are shown in FIG. **14A**, it is to be appreciated that any number of connectors **1455** may be included in the array of PMFs **1400.sub.A** and **1400.sub.B**. The connectors **1455** in FIG. **14A** may be substantially similar to the connectors **1355** in FIG. **13A**. However, in other embodiments, the connectors **1455** may have lenses similar to the connectors **1355** shown in FIG. **13B**.

(95) Referring now to FIG. **14B**, a perspective view illustration of a plurality of PMFs **1400** connected with angled connectors **1455** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, the angled connectors **1455** may have a 90° turn. Though, it is to be appreciated that other embodiments may include turns of different angles. The turn may be implemented with the use of a mirror at the corner of the connector **1455**. In an embodiment, the angled connectors **1455** may be substantially similar to the connector **1355** in FIG. **13C**. In FIG. **14B**, ten pairs of PMFs **1400.sub.A** and **1400.sub.B** are shown. However, it is to be appreciated that any number of PMFs **1400** may be used in accordance with various embodiments. In an embodiment, the connectors **1455** may be discrete components. In other embodiments, the connectors **1455** may be coupled together.

(96) Referring now to FIGS. **15A-15C**, a series of cross-sectional illustrations of PMFs **1500** and coupled PMFs **1500** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, the PMFs **1500** include alignment features that allow for mechanically coupling the PMFs **1500** so that they are properly aligned.

(97) Referring now to FIG. **15A**, a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF **1500** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, the PMF **1500** may comprise a core **1512** and a first cladding **1510** around the core **1512**. A pair of rods **1515** may be provided on opposite sides of the core **1512**. In an embodiment, the rods **1515** may comprise boron trioxide (**B.sub.2O.sub.3**) or another material useful as stress rods in PMFs **1500**. That is, the rods **1515** may not be magnetic in some embodiments. However, it is to be appreciated that one or both of the rods **1515** may be magnetic, similar to embodiments described in greater detail above. In an embodiment, a second cladding **1509** may surround the first cladding **1510**.

(98) In an embodiment, an alignment feature may be provided in the second cladding **1509**. The alignment feature may include a protrusion **1542** and a groove **1541**. The protrusions **1542** and the groove **1541** may be on opposite sides of the second cladding **1509**. In an embodiment, the protrusion **1542** and the groove **1541** may be aligned with the core **1512** and the rods **1515**. That is, a single linear line can be drawn through the protrusion **1542**, the rods **1515**, the core **1512**, and the groove **1541**. The protrusion **1542** may be a shape that will couple with the groove **1541**. For example, in FIG. **15A**, the protrusion **1542** is triangular shaped and the groove **1541** is a matching triangle shape. However, it is to be appreciated that other shapes may be used for the protrusion **1542** and the groove **1541**.

(99) Referring now to FIG. **15B**, a cross-sectional illustration of a plurality of PMFs **1500** that are coupled together is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, the PMFs **1500** may be substantially similar to the PMFs **1500** shown in FIG. **15A** is shown, in accordance with an

embodiment. As shown, the alignment features (i.e., the protrusions **1542** and the grooves **1541**) allow for the PMFs **1500** to be coupled to each other while maintaining alignment of the cores **1512** and the rods **1515**. In the illustrated embodiment, three PMFs **1500** are shown, but it is to be appreciated that any number of PMFs **1500** may be coupled together in a similar fashion.

(100) Referring now to FIG. **15C**, a cross-sectional illustration of the plurality of PMFs **1500** that are embedded in a mold layer **1511** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, the mold layer **1511** may be any molding material in order to bundle the PMFs **1500** into a ribbon. The ribbon may have the mold layer **1511** along a length of the PMFs **1500** with a pigtail feature at the end of the PMFs **1500**.

(101) Referring now to FIGS. **16A-16C**, a series of cross-sectional illustrations of PMFs **1600** are shown, in accordance with various embodiments. In an embodiment, the PMFs **1600** may have one of two different alignment structures. The different alignment structures interface with each other. As such, a first type of PMF **1600** may alternate with a second type of PMF **1600**.

(102) Referring now to FIG. **16A**, a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF **1600** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, the PMF **1600** may comprise a core **1612** and a first cladding **1610** around the core **1612**. A pair of rods **1615** may be provided on opposite sides of the core **1612**. In an embodiment, the rods **1615** may comprise boron trioxide (B.sub.2O.sub.3) or another material useful as stress rods in PMFs **1600**. That is, the rods **1615** may not be magnetic in some embodiments. However, it is to be appreciated that one or both of the rods **1615** may be magnetic, similar to embodiments described in greater detail above. In an embodiment, a second cladding **1609** may surround the first cladding **1610**.

(103) In an embodiment, an alignment feature is provided in the second cladding **1609**. The alignment feature may include a pair of protrusions **1642**. In an embodiment, the protrusions **1642** may be on opposite sides of the second cladding **1609**. Additionally, the protrusions **1642** may be aligned with the rods **1615** and the core **1612**. The protrusions **1642** are shown as triangular protrusions, but it is to be appreciated that other protrusion shapes may also be used.

(104) Referring now to FIG. **16B**, a cross-sectional illustration of a second type of PMF **1600** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. The PMF **1600** in FIG. **16B** may be substantially similar to the PMF **1600** in FIG. **16A**, with the exception of having a different alignment feature. Particularly, the alignment feature in FIG. **16B** may be complimentary to the alignment feature in FIG. **16A**. For example, grooves **1641** may be provided on opposite sides of the second cladding **1609**. In the illustrated embodiment, the grooves **1641** are shown as being triangular in shape. However, it is to be appreciated that the grooves **1641** may be any shape that interfaces with the shape of the protrusions in the other PMF **1600**.

(105) Referring now to FIG. **16C**, a cross-sectional illustration of an array of PMFs **1600** that are embedded in a mold layer **1611** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, the PMFs **1600** may include both types of PMFs **1600** shown in FIGS. **16A** and **16B**. For example, the center PMF **1600** is similar to the PMF **1600** in FIG. **16A**, and the outer PMFs **1600** are similar to the PMF **1600** in FIG. **16B**. That is, by alternating which type of PMF **1600** is used, an aligned chain of PMFs **1600** can be provided with any desired number of PMFs **1600**.

(106) Referring now to FIGS. **17A-17E**, a series of cross-sectional illustrations depicting PMFs **1700** and arrays of PMFs **1700** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In the embodiment shown in FIGS. **17A-17E**, pairs of PMFs **1700** are coupled together, and a plurality of pairs can be placed adjacent to each other to form an array.

(107) Referring now to FIG. **17A**, a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF **1700** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, the PMF **1700** may comprise a core **1712** and a first cladding **1710** around the core **1712**. A pair of rods **1715** may be provided on opposite sides of the core **1712**. In an embodiment, the rods **1715** may comprise boron trioxide (B.sub.2O.sub.3) or another material useful as stress rods in PMFs **1700**. That is, the rods **1715** may not be magnetic in some embodiments. However, it is to be appreciated that one or both of the rods **1715** may be

magnetic, similar to embodiments described in greater detail above. In an embodiment, a second cladding **1709** may surround the first cladding **1710**.

(108) In an embodiment, an alignment feature may be provided in the second cladding **1709**. The alignment feature may include a protrusion **1742**. In an embodiment, the protrusion **1742** may be aligned with the core **1712** and the rods **1715**. That is, a single linear line can be drawn through the protrusion **1742**, the rods **1515**, and the core **1712**. The protrusion **1742** may be a shape that will couple with a groove on a second PMF **1700**. For example, in FIG. **17A**, the protrusion **1742** is triangular shaped. However, it is to be appreciated that other shapes may be used for the protrusion **1742**.

(109) Referring now to FIG. **17B**, a cross-sectional illustration of a second type of PMF **1700** is shown, in accordance with an additional embodiment. In an embodiment, the second PMF **1700** may be substantially similar to the first PMF **1700** described above in FIG. **17A**, with the exception of the alignment feature. Instead of a protrusion **1742**, the PMF **1700** includes a groove **1741**. The groove **1741** may be a shape that interfaces with the protrusions **1742** of the first type of PMF **1700**.

(110) Referring now to FIG. **17C**, a cross-sectional illustration of a pair of PMFs **1700** that are coupled together is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. As shown, the PMF **1700** on the left has a protrusion **1742**, and the PMF **1700** on the right side has a groove **1741**. The protrusion **1742** fits into the groove **1741** to couple the two PMFs **1700** together with proper alignment. That is, the rods **1715** in both PMFs **1700** are aligned with each other in a straight line.

(111) Referring now to FIG. **17D**, a cross-sectional illustration of a plurality of PMFs **1700** are aligned together in an array is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. The plurality of PMFs **1700** includes two pairs of coupled PMFs **1700**. That is, the coupled pairs may be aligned next to other coupled pairs to form an array.

(112) Referring now to FIG. **17E**, a cross-sectional illustration of the array of PMFs **1700** after a mold layer **1711** is applied around the PMFs **1700** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, the mold layer **1711** may be pressed between plates **1756** and **1757**. The plates **1756** and **1757** may be glass or any other rigid structure. In some embodiments, the plates **1756** and **1757** may be removed after the mold layer **1711** is cured.

(113) Referring now to FIGS. **18A-18C**, a series of cross-sectional illustrations of PMFs **1800** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. The PMFs **1800** depict the formation of various alignment structures that can be used to align PMFs **1800** so the rods and cores of multiple PMFs **1800** remain in alignment.

(114) Referring now to FIG. **18A**, a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF **1800** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, the PMF **1800** may comprise a core **1812** with a first cladding **1810**. A pair of rods **1815** are on opposite sides of the core **1812** within the first cladding **1810**. In an embodiment, a second cladding **1809** surrounds the first cladding **1810**. Marking rods **1817** are provided in the second cladding **1809** on opposite sides of the core **1812**. The marking rods **1817** may be partially embedded in the second cladding **1809** so that a portion of the marking rods **1817** become protrusions. In an embodiment, the marking rods **1817** may be a material that is different than the second cladding **1809**. In some embodiments, the marking rods **1817** comprise the same material as the rods **1815**. The marking rods **1817** may also have a similar diameter as the rods **1815**.

(115) Referring now to FIG. **18B**, a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF **1800** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. The PMF **1800** in FIG. **18B** is substantially similar to the PMF **1800** in FIG. **18A**, with the exception of one of the marking rods **1817** being removed. The removal of the marking rod **1817** on the right side of the PMF **1800** results in the formation of a groove **1841**.

(116) Referring now to FIG. **18C**, a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF **1800** is shown, in accordance with an additional embodiment. The PMF **1800** in FIG. **18C** is substantially similar to

the PMF **1800** in FIG. **18B**, with the exception of the second marking rod **1817** being removed. As such, the PMF **1800** includes a pair of grooves **1841**.

(117) Referring now to FIGS. **19A** and **19B**, a pair of cross-sectional illustrations depicting PMFs **1900** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In the embodiments shown in FIGS. **19A** and **19B**, a single alignment feature is provided in the PMFs **1900**.

(118) Referring now to FIG. **19A**, a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF **1900** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. In an embodiment, the PMF **1900** may comprise a core **1912** with a first cladding **1910**. A pair of rods **1915** are on opposite sides of the core **1912** within the first cladding **1910**. In an embodiment, a second cladding **1909** surrounds the first cladding **1910**. A marking rod **1917** is provided in the second cladding **1909** on one side of the core **1912**. The marking rod **1917** may be partially embedded in the second cladding **1909** so that a portion of the marking rod **1917** becomes a protrusion. In an embodiment, the marking rod **1917** may be a material that is different than the second cladding **1909**. In some embodiments, the marking rod **1917** comprises the same material as the rods **1915**. The marking rod **1917** may also have a similar diameter as the rods **1915**.

(119) Referring now to FIG. **19B**, a cross-sectional illustration of a PMF **1900** is shown, in accordance with an additional embodiment. The PMF **1900** in FIG. **19B** may be substantially similar to the PMF **1900** in FIG. **19A**, with the exception of the marking rod **1917** being removed. The removal of the marking rod **1917** results in the formation of a groove **1941**. The groove **1941** may be sized to receive a protrusion, such as the exposed portion of the marking rod **1917** in FIG. **19A**.

(120) Referring now to FIG. **20**, a cross-sectional illustration of an electronic system **2090** is shown, in accordance with an embodiment. The electronic system **2090** comprises a board **2091**, such as a printed circuit board (PCB). In an embodiment, a package substrate **2093** is coupled to the board **2091** by interconnects **2092**. The interconnects **2092** are shown as solder balls, but it is to be appreciated that any interconnect architecture may be used. In an embodiment, a PIC **2093** is coupled to the package substrate **2093** by interconnects **2095**. A PMF **2000** may be set into a groove on the PIC **2096**. In an embodiment, the PMF **2000** may be similar to any of the PMFs described herein. In an embodiment, a die **2094** (e.g., a processor or the like) may be coupled to the PIC **2096** through the package substrate **2093**.

(121) FIG. **21** illustrates a computing device **2100** in accordance with one implementation of the invention. The computing device **2100** houses a board **2102**. The board **2102** may include a number of components, including but not limited to a processor **2104** and at least one communication chip **2106**. The processor **2104** is physically and electrically coupled to the board **2102**. In some implementations the at least one communication chip **2106** is also physically and electrically coupled to the board **2102**. In further implementations, the communication chip **2106** is part of the processor **2104**.

(122) These other components include, but are not limited to, volatile memory (e.g., DRAM), non-volatile memory (e.g., ROM), flash memory, a graphics processor, a digital signal processor, a crypto processor, a chipset, an antenna, a display, a touchscreen display, a touchscreen controller, a battery, an audio codec, a video codec, a power amplifier, a global positioning system (GPS) device, a compass, an accelerometer, a gyroscope, a speaker, a camera, and a mass storage device (such as hard disk drive, compact disk (CD), digital versatile disk (DVD), and so forth).

(123) The communication chip **2106** enables wireless communications for the transfer of data to and from the computing device **2100**. The term “wireless” and its derivatives may be used to describe circuits, devices, systems, methods, techniques, communications channels, etc., that may communicate data through the use of modulated electromagnetic radiation through a non-solid medium. The term does not imply that the associated devices do not contain any wires, although in some embodiments they might not. The communication chip **2106** may implement any of a number of wireless standards or protocols, including but not limited to Wi-Fi (IEEE 802.11 family),

WiMAX (IEEE 802.16 family), IEEE 802.20, long term evolution (LTE), Ev-DO, HSPA+, HSDPA+, HSUPA+, EDGE, GSM, GPRS, CDMA, TDMA, DECT, Bluetooth, derivatives thereof, as well as any other wireless protocols that are designated as 3G, 4G, 5G, and beyond. The computing device **2100** may include a plurality of communication chips **2106**. For instance, a first communication chip **2106** may be dedicated to shorter range wireless communications such as Wi-Fi and Bluetooth and a second communication chip **2106** may be dedicated to longer range wireless communications such as GPS, EDGE, GPRS, CDMA, WiMAX, LTE, Ev-DO, and others.

(124) The processor **2104** of the computing device **2100** includes an integrated circuit die packaged within the processor **2104**. In some implementations of the invention, the integrated circuit die of the processor may be part of an electronic package that comprises a PIC with a fiber ribbon that includes aligned PMFs, in accordance with embodiments described herein. The term “processor” may refer to any device or portion of a device that processes electronic data from registers and/or memory to transform that electronic data into other electronic data that may be stored in registers and/or memory.

(125) The communication chip **2106** also includes an integrated circuit die packaged within the communication chip **2106**. In accordance with another implementation of the invention, the integrated circuit die of the communication chip may be part of an electronic package that comprises a PIC with a fiber ribbon that includes aligned PMFs, in accordance with embodiments described herein.

(126) The above description of illustrated implementations of the invention, including what is described in the Abstract, is not intended to be exhaustive or to limit the invention to the precise forms disclosed. While specific implementations of, and examples for, the invention are described herein for illustrative purposes, various equivalent modifications are possible within the scope of the invention, as those skilled in the relevant art will recognize.

(127) These modifications may be made to the invention in light of the above detailed description. The terms used in the following claims should not be construed to limit the invention to the specific implementations disclosed in the specification and the claims. Rather, the scope of the invention is to be determined entirely by the following claims, which are to be construed in accordance with established doctrines of claim interpretation.

(128) Example 1: an optical fiber comprising: a core; a cladding around the core; a first rod within the cladding and adjacent to the core, wherein the first rod comprises a magnetic material; and a second rod within the cladding and adjacent to the core, wherein the first rod and the second rod are on opposite sides of the core.

(129) Example 2: the optical fiber of Example 1, wherein the second rod comprises a magnetic material.

(130) Example 3: the optical fiber of Example 1 or Example 2, wherein the second rod comprises a material that is magnetically attracted to the first rod.

(131) Example 4: the optical fiber of Examples 1-3, wherein the first rod and the second rod are cylindrical.

(132) Example 5: the optic fiber of Examples 1-4, wherein the magnetic material comprises a magnetic powder.

(133) Example 6: the optical fiber of Example 5, wherein the magnetic powder is mixed with a conductor.

(134) Example 7: the optical fiber of Examples 1-6, further comprising: a third rod within the cladding and adjacent to the core; and a fourth rod within the cladding and adjacent to the core, wherein a line between the third rod and the fourth rod is substantially orthogonal to a line between the first rod and the second rod.

(135) Example 8: the optical fiber of Example 7, wherein the third rod comprises a magnetic material.

(136) Example 9: the optical fiber of Example 8, wherein the fourth rod comprises a magnetic

material.

(137) Example 10: a fiber ribbon, comprising: a plurality of optical fibers laterally adjacent to each other, wherein individual ones of the optical fibers comprise: a core; a cladding around the core; a first rod within the cladding and adjacent to the core, wherein the first rod comprises a magnetic material; and a second rod within the cladding and adjacent to the core, wherein the first rod and the second rod are on opposite sides of the core; and a mold material around the plurality of optical fibers, and wherein ends of the plurality of optical fibers extend past an end of the mold material.

(138) Example 11: fiber ribbon of Example 10, wherein the plurality of optical fibers are aligned with each other so that the first rods and the second rods are all lined up with each other.

(139) Example 12: the fiber ribbon of Example 11, wherein first rods are adjacent to second rods.

(140) Example 13: the fiber ribbon of Examples 10-12, wherein the second rod comprises a magnetic material.

(141) Example 14: the fiber ribbon of Examples 10-13, wherein the magnetic material comprises a magnetic powder.

(142) Example 15: the fiber ribbon of Example 14, wherein the magnetic powder is mixed with a magnetic metal.

(143) Example 16: the fiber ribbon of Examples 10-15, wherein the second rods comprises a material that is magnetically attracted to the first rods.

(144) Example 17: the fiber ribbon of Examples 10-16, wherein the first rods and the second rods are cylindrical.

(145) Example 18: an electronic package, comprising: a groove in a fiber array unit; a fiber in the groove, wherein the fiber comprises: a core; a cladding around the core; a first rod within the cladding and adjacent to the core, wherein the first rod comprises a magnetic material; and a second rod within the cladding and adjacent to the core, wherein the first rod and the second rod are on opposite sides of the core.

(146) Example 19: the electronic package of Example 18, wherein the groove is a v-groove.

(147) Example 20: the electronic package of Example 19, wherein the fiber is aligned in the v-groove by applying a magnetic field to the fiber.

(148) Example 21: the electronic package of Examples 18-20, wherein the groove is a square groove with a bottom surface and a pair of sidewall surfaces.

(149) Example 22: the electronic package of Example 21, wherein magnetic metal slugs are recessed into the pair of sidewall surfaces, and wherein the magnetic material is attracted to the magnetic metal slugs.

(150) Example 23: an electronic system, comprising: a board; a package substrate coupled to the board; a photonics integrated circuit (PIC) coupled to the package substrate; and a polarization maintaining fiber (PMF) coupled to the PIC, wherein the PMF comprises: a core; a cladding around the core; a first rod within the cladding and adjacent to the core, wherein the first rod comprises a magnetic material; and a second rod within the cladding and adjacent to the core, wherein the first rod and the second rod are on opposite sides of the core.

(151) Example 24: the electronic system of Example 23, wherein the second rod comprises a magnetic material.

(152) Example 25: the electronic system of Example 23 or Example 24, wherein the second rod comprises a material that is magnetically attracted to the first rod.

(153) Example 26: an optical fiber, comprising: a core; a first cladding around the core; a first rod within the first cladding and adjacent to the core; a second rod within the first cladding and adjacent to the core, wherein the first rod and the second rod are on opposite sides of the core; a second cladding around the first cladding; and a housing at least partially around a perimeter of the second cladding at an end of the optical fiber.

(154) Example 27: the optical fiber of Example 26, wherein the second cladding is secured to the housing with an adhesive.

(155) Example 28: the optical fiber of Example 26 or Example 27, wherein the second cladding comprises a first protrusion and a second protrusion, wherein the housing comprises a first groove and a second groove.

(156) Example 29: the optical fiber of Example 28, wherein the first protrusion inserts into the first groove, and wherein the second protrusion inserts into the second groove.

(157) Example 30: the optical fiber of Example 29 wherein the first protrusion is laterally adjacent to the first rod, and wherein the second protrusion is laterally adjacent to the second rod.

(158) Example 31: the optical fiber of Examples 26-30, wherein the second cladding comprises a first groove and a second groove, wherein the housing comprises a first protrusion and a second protrusion.

(159) Example 32: the optical fiber of Example 31, wherein the first protrusion inserts into the first groove, and wherein the second protrusion inserts into the second groove.

(160) Example 33: the optical fiber of Example 32, wherein the first groove is laterally adjacent to the first rod, and wherein the second groove is laterally adjacent to the second rod.

(161) Example 34: the optical fiber of Examples 26-33, wherein the housing comprises a latch.

(162) Example 35: the optical fiber of Example 34, wherein the latch secures the optical fiber into a connector.

(163) Example 36: the optical fiber of Example 35, wherein the connector is a linear connector.

(164) Example 37: the optical fiber of Example 35, wherein the connector is an angled connector.

(165) Example 38: the optical fiber module, comprising: a first polarization maintaining (PM) fiber; a first housing at an end of the first PM fiber; a connector, wherein the first housing is secured by a first end of the connector; a second PM fiber; a second housing at an end of the second PM fiber, wherein the second housing is secured by a second end of the connector.

(166) Example 39: the optical fiber module of Example 38, wherein the connector is a linear connector.

(167) Example 40: the optical fiber module of Example 38, wherein the connector is an angled connector.

(168) Example 41: the optical fiber module of Example 40, wherein the connector comprises a mirror or prism to optically couple the first end of the connector to the second end of the connector.

(169) Example 42: the optical fiber module of Examples 38-41, further comprising: a first lens within the connector and adjacent to the first end of the connector; and a second lens within the connector and adjacent to the second end of the connector.

(170) Example 43: the optical fiber module of Examples 38-42, wherein the first housing aligns the first PM fiber with the connector and the second housing aligns the second PM fiber with the connector.

(171) Example 44: the optical fiber module of Example 43, wherein the first housing and the second housing comprise protrusions that interface with grooves on the first PM fiber and the second PM fiber.

(172) Example 45: the optical fiber module of Examples 38-44, wherein the first housing and the second housing comprise grooves that interface with protrusions on the first PM fiber and the second PM fiber.

(173) Example 46: the optical fiber module of Examples 38-45, wherein the first housing is adhered to the first PM fiber with a first adhesive, and wherein the second housing is adhered to the second PM fiber with a second adhesive.

(174) Example 47: the optical fiber module of Examples 38-46, wherein the first housing is secured to the first end of the connector by a first latching mechanism, and wherein the second housing is secured to the second end of the connector by a second latching mechanism.

(175) Example 48: an electronic system, comprising: a board; a package substrate coupled to the board; a photonics integrated circuit (PIC) coupled to the package substrate; and a polarization maintaining fiber (PMF) coupled to the PIC, wherein the PMF comprises: a core; a first cladding

around the core; a first rod within the first cladding and adjacent to the core; a second rod within the first cladding and adjacent to the core, wherein the first rod and the second rod are on opposite sides of the core; a second cladding around the first cladding; and a housing at least partially around a perimeter of the second cladding at an end of the PMF.

(176) Example 49: the electronic system of Example 48, wherein the second cladding comprises protrusions that interface with grooves in the housing.

(177) Example 50: the electronic system of Example 48 or Example 49, wherein the second cladding comprises grooves that interface with protrusions from the housing.

(178) Example 51: a polarization maintaining fiber (PMF), comprising: a core; a first cladding around the core; a first rod within the cladding and adjacent to the core; a second rod within the cladding and adjacent to the core, wherein the first rod and the second rod are on opposite sides of the core; a second cladding around the first cladding; and an alignment feature integrated with the second cladding.

(179) Example 52: the PMF of Example 51, wherein the alignment feature comprises a marking rod partially embedded in the second cladding.

(180) Example 53: the PMF of Example 52, wherein the alignment feature further comprises a second marking rod partially embedded in the second cladding.

(181) Example 54: the PMF of Example 52, wherein the alignment feature further comprises a groove in the second cladding, wherein the groove is on an opposite side of the second cladding from the marking rod.

(182) Example 55: the PMF of Example 52, wherein the marking rod is a different material than the second cladding.

(183) Example 56: the PMF of Example 52, wherein the marking rod is the same material as the first rod and the second rod.

(184) Example 57: the PMF of Example 52, wherein the marking rod is circular.

(185) Example 58: the PMF of Example 57, wherein a diameter of the marking rod is substantially similar to a diameter of the first rod.

(186) Example 59: the PMF of Examples 51-58, wherein the alignment feature comprises a groove in the second cladding.

(187) Example 60: the PMF of Example 59, wherein the alignment feature further comprises a second groove in the second cladding, wherein the second groove is on an opposite side of the second cladding from the groove.

(188) Example 61: a fiber ribbon, comprising: a first polarization maintaining fiber (PMF), wherein the first PMF comprises a first alignment feature; a second PMF laterally adjacent to the first PMF, wherein the second PMF comprises a second alignment feature that interfaces with the first alignment feature in order to align the first PMF with the second PMF; and a mold material around the first PMF and the second PMF.

(189) Example 62: the fiber ribbon of Example 61, wherein the first alignment feature is the same as the second alignment feature.

(190) Example 63: the fiber ribbon of Example 62, wherein the first alignment feature comprises a protrusion and a groove, and wherein the protrusion and the groove are on opposite sides of the first PMF.

(191) Example 64: the fiber ribbon of Examples 61-63, wherein the first alignment feature is different than the second alignment feature.

(192) Example 65: the fiber ribbon of Example 64, wherein the first alignment feature comprises a first protrusion and a second protrusion, wherein the first protrusion and the second protrusion are on opposite sides of the first PMF, and wherein the second alignment feature comprises a first groove and a second groove, wherein the first groove and the second groove are on opposite sides of the second PMF.

(193) Example 66: the fiber ribbon of Example 64, wherein the first alignment feature comprises a

protrusion, and wherein the second alignment feature comprises a groove.

(194) Example 67: the fiber ribbon of Examples 61-66, further comprising three or more PMFs.

(195) Example 68: the fiber ribbon of Examples 61-67, wherein the first PMF and the second PMF each comprise: a core; a first cladding around the core; a first rod in the first cladding adjacent to the core; a second rod in the first cladding adjacent to the core, wherein the first rod and the second rod are on opposite sides of the core; and a second cladding around the first cladding.

(196) Example 69: the fiber ribbon of Example 68, wherein the first rods and the second rods of the first PMF and the second PMF are aligned in a line.

(197) Example 70: the fiber ribbon of Example 68, wherein the first alignment feature and the second alignment feature are formed on the second cladding.

(198) Example 71: the fiber ribbon of Example 68, wherein the first alignment feature comprises a rod partially embedded in the second cladding.

(199) Example 72: the fiber ribbon of Example 71, wherein the second alignment feature comprises a groove in the second cladding.

(200) Example 73: the fiber ribbon of Example 71, wherein the first alignment feature further comprises a groove in the second cladding, wherein the groove is on an opposite side of the second cladding from the rod.

(201) Example 74: an electronic package, comprising: a board; a package substrate coupled to the board; a photonics integrated circuit (PIC) coupled to the package substrate; and a fiber ribbon optically coupled to the PIC, wherein the fiber ribbon comprises: a first polarization maintaining fiber (PMF), wherein the first PMF comprises a first alignment feature; a second PMF laterally adjacent to the first PMF, wherein the second PMF comprises a second alignment feature that interfaces with the first alignment feature in order to align the first PMF with the second PMF; and a mold material around the first PMF and the second PMF.

(202) Example 75: the electronic package of Example 74, wherein the first alignment feature is the same as the second alignment feature.

Claims

1. An optical fiber comprising: a core; a cladding around the core; a first rod within the cladding and adjacent to the core, wherein the first rod comprises a magnetic material, the magnetic material comprising a magnetic powder mixed with a conductor; and a second rod within the cladding and adjacent to the core, wherein the first rod and the second rod are on opposite sides of the core.
2. The optical fiber of claim 1, wherein the second rod comprises a magnetic material.
3. The optical fiber of claim 1, wherein the second rod comprises a material that is magnetically attracted to the first rod.
4. The optical fiber of claim 1, wherein the first rod and the second rod are cylindrical.
5. The optical fiber of claim 1, further comprising: a third rod within the cladding and adjacent to the core; and a fourth rod within the cladding and adjacent to the core, wherein a line between the third rod and the fourth rod is substantially orthogonal to a line between the first rod and the second rod.
6. The optical fiber of claim 5, wherein the third rod comprises a magnetic material.
7. The optical fiber of claim 6, wherein the fourth rod comprises a magnetic material.
8. A fiber ribbon, comprising: a plurality of optical fibers laterally adjacent to each other, wherein individual ones of the optical fibers comprise: a core; a cladding around the core; a first rod within the cladding and adjacent to the core, wherein the first rod comprises a magnetic material; and a second rod within the cladding and adjacent to the core, wherein the first rod and the second rod are on opposite sides of the core; and a mold material around the plurality of optical fibers, and wherein ends of the plurality of optical fibers extend past an end of the mold material.
9. The fiber ribbon of claim 8, wherein the plurality of optical fibers are aligned with each other so

that the first rods and the second rods are all lined up with each other.

10. The fiber ribbon of claim 9, wherein first rods are adjacent to second rods.

11. The fiber ribbon of claim 8, wherein the second rod comprises a magnetic material.

12. The fiber ribbon of claim 8, wherein the magnetic material comprises a magnetic powder.

13. The fiber ribbon of claim 12, wherein the magnetic powder is mixed with a magnetic metal.

14. The fiber ribbon of claim 8, wherein the second rods comprises a material that is magnetically attracted to the first rods.

15. The fiber ribbon of claim 8, wherein the first rods and the second rods are cylindrical.

16. An electronic package, comprising: a groove in a fiber array unit; a fiber in the groove, wherein the fiber comprises: a core; a cladding around the core; a first rod within the cladding and adjacent to the core, wherein the first rod comprises a magnetic material; and a second rod within the cladding and adjacent to the core, wherein the first rod and the second rod are on opposite sides of the core.

17. The electronic package of claim 16, wherein the groove is a v-groove.

18. The electronic package of claim 17, wherein the fiber is aligned in the v-groove by applying a magnetic field to the fiber.

19. The electronic package of claim 16, wherein the groove is a square groove with a bottom surface and a pair of sidewall surfaces.

20. The electronic package of claim 19, wherein magnetic metal slugs are recessed into the pair of sidewall surfaces, and wherein the magnetic material is attracted to the magnetic metal slugs.

21. An electronic system, comprising: a board; a package substrate coupled to the board; a photonics integrated circuit (PIC) coupled to the package substrate; and a polarization maintaining fiber (PMF) coupled to the PIC, wherein the PMF comprises: a core; a cladding around the core; a first rod within the cladding and adjacent to the core, wherein the first rod comprises a magnetic material; and a second rod within the cladding and adjacent to the core, wherein the first rod and the second rod are on opposite sides of the core.

22. The electronic system of claim 21, wherein the second rod comprises a magnetic material.

23. The electronic system of claim 21, wherein the second rod comprises a material that is magnetically attracted to the first rod.

24. An optical fiber comprising: a core; a cladding around the core; a first rod within the cladding and adjacent to the core, wherein the first rod comprises a magnetic material; and a second rod within the cladding and adjacent to the core, wherein the first rod and the second rod are on opposite sides of the core, wherein the second rod comprises a material that is magnetically attracted to the first rod.
